

HUES IN CHARGE
(clockwise from previous page) Rukmini Kadam's study done using colour drenching technique; blue tone and pink tone bedrooms also use the same design style



Mumbai-based, Rukmini Ray Kadam is the founder of Trumatter, a popular home decor blog and TrumatterLiving, a boutique home and living brand. @trumatter (Instagram)



Make your furniture pop

Colour drenching is not just about making a bold statement it also creates a seamless backdrop that for your furniture and decor to shine. The cohesive canvas that makes everything else in the room pop.

No more small, awkward spaces

If you have smaller spaces, it's particularly effective in those areas. To make a room look large and airy, simply pick a light or a mid shade and drench all five walls and trims in the same colour. This blurs where the walls and the ceiling meet, creating an illusion of space. Apply the technique in hallways and passages or at places where you have odd angles.

For peaceful and calm rooms

When you paint walls, ceilings, trims and skirtings in the same colour, it creates a visually clean, tranquil effect. This happens because it blurs the harsh contrasts.

Do's and don'ts

To begin with, pick a paint that's matte and flat. Steer clear of sheen or shine. Matte and flat paints create richer, more pigmented finish and that is ideal for colour drenching. I would recommend chalk paint for trims and wall paint for walls. One can also use chalk paint on walls as I have—mine is Coolabah green from Annie Sloan. Make sure to seal it with a matte lacquer. I have found this to be the most matte and pigmented as opposed to any other. Don't paint everything or buy everything in the same shade. Look for complementary textures and colours to create interest. I added an oak bookshelf and carried the same tone to our rug and our study table.